



# Proposed CEA Link — December 2026

How this rota would work from December 2026, and how it compares with today's link

Prepared 29 September 2026 · every figure is calculated from the rota, not entered by hand

## PROPOSAL

### Cover at Seventeen

Cover weeks at lines 1, 7, 12 and 17, so nobody works more than 13 shifts without a two-day break

CODE **C17-24-EXT**

FINGERPRINT **edc1b731**

SET AGAINST today's 20-week link

CREATED 22 September 2026

- ✓ **24** lines, one per person
- ✓ **35h 00m** a week Mon–Sat, on average — exactly the contract
- ✓ longest run **9** days (limit 13)
- ✓ **0** rests under 12h
- ▲ **3** avoidable tiring patterns (today 5)
- ▲ **8** of 11 December staffing rules not met

**What this is.** Cover at Seventeen is a proposal for the CEA link on the December 2026 timetable: a 24-week rotation for 24 people, where today's link has 20. It is for discussion, not a decision — it has not yet been through the roster office or a union rep.

#### DOES IT MEET THE DECEMBER STAFFING LEVELS?

### 3 of 11

rules met — 8 not met  
today's link meets 4 · each rule on page 6

#### CAN IT BE RUN WITHIN THE LIMITS?

### Yes

inside every hard limit  
shortest gap 13h35 (limit 12h) ·  
most days in a row 9 (limit 13) ·  
35-hour contract exact

#### IS IT TIRING?

### 3

avoidable tiring patterns  
today's link has 5 · cover weeks at their worst · page 7

#### WHAT DOES IT TAKE?

### 24 people

4 more than today's 20  
4 cover weeks for leave and sickness · 9 on a Sunday as overtime (today 8)

#### ARE STAFF WHERE THE TRAINS ARE?

### Closer

than today overall — less close on Thursday  
weekdays 38.5 (today 52.0) ·  
Sat 20.7 (65.9) · Sun 64.8 (71.7) · 0 is a perfect match · page 5

### 5 in 24

full weekends off  
one in 5 weeks — today one in 5 (4 in 20)

### 48 a year

finishes at 23:00 or later, each  
today 39 · about one extra every 6 weeks

### 54 a year

starts at 06:20, the open, each  
today 62 · about one fewer every 6 or 7 weeks

#### Likely positives for staff

- Shorter weekday closing shift
- Some Saturday closing shifts shorter
- The average shift 11 minutes shorter
- Shortest rest between shifts 13h35 (today 12h30)
- Fewer tiring patterns — 3 (today 5)
- 13 of its 19 shift times are already worked today

#### What colleagues may be concerned about

- More six-day weeks — 3 (today 1)
- More single rest days, which are not a two-day break — 12 (today 4)
- About 5 more days at work a year
- More late finishes — about one extra every 6 weeks each
- Worse than today on too little rest after a run of early starts (5, today 3) and start times that jump by more than two hours (10, today 6)
- Staff follow the trains less closely than today on Thursday
- ...and 2 more — see page 2

#### Still to settle

- **Rule not met:** At least four on at the open, every day — here 4 · 5 · 3.
- **Rule not met:** At least five still on duty at 22:00, every day — here 4–6 · 3 · 3.
- **Rule not met:** Fourteen on a Saturday, ten on a Sunday — here 12 · 9.
- **Rule not met:** Four cover weeks, evenly spread — here lines 1, 7, 12, 17.
- **Rule not met:** The ticket office: two early and two late, identical shifts, every day — here Mon–Fri no · Sat no · Sun no.
- **Rule not met:** Every weekday closer starts at 15:45 — here closers start at 16:25.
- **Rule not met:** At least two on the floor at every moment — here fewest 3 · 3 · 1.
- **Rule not met:** No more shift times than today — here 19.
- **Which link is used.** This is a proposal; colleagues' views come first.
- **Then who starts on which line.** The rota does not say who works which week.

# What changes, in numbers

Today's 20-week link beside Cover at Seventeen. Green is better than today, amber is worse, unshaded is neither.

| QUESTION                                                            | TODAY              | COVER AT SEVENTEEN      | IN PLAIN WORDS                                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| People on the link                                                  | 20                 | 24                      | 4 more people, one per line                                                                            |
| On duty each day — weekday · Saturday · Sunday                      | 11-12 · 10 · 8     | 13-16 · 12 · 9          | the December levels ask for 14 on a Saturday and 10 on a Sunday                                        |
| On at the open — weekday · Sat · Sun                                | 4 · 4 · 3          | 4 · 5 · 3               | at least 4 every day — not met                                                                         |
| Still on duty at 22:00 — weekday · Sat · Sun                        | 4 · 2 · 3          | 4-6 · 3 · 3             | at least 5 every day — not met                                                                         |
| Through to the close — weekday · Sat · Sun                          | 2 · 2 · 3          | 3-4 · 3 · 3             | at least 3 every day — met                                                                             |
| How closely staff follow the trains — weekday · Sat · Sun           | 52.0 · 65.9 · 71.7 | 38.5 · 20.7 · 64.8      | lower is closer; 0 would be a perfect match — see page 5                                               |
| Cover weeks — for leave and sickness                                | lines 1, 7, 12, 17 | lines 1, 7, 12, 17      | not evenly spaced (gaps of 6, 5, 5 and 8 weeks)                                                        |
| Most days worked in a row                                           | 9                  | 9                       | Chiltern's limit is 13 (written source to confirm)                                                     |
| Shortest gap between two shifts                                     | 12h30              | 13h35                   | the limit is 12 hours                                                                                  |
| Full weekends off                                                   | 4 in 20            | 5 in 24                 | one in 5 weeks, against one in 5 today                                                                 |
| Days at work a year, not counting Sundays                           | 219                | 224                     | Sundays are overtime; a cover week counts as 4 days                                                    |
| Average shift · longest shift                                       | 8h14 · 9h10        | 8h03 · 9h10             | the average is Monday to Saturday; the longest is on any day                                           |
| Early shifts, shortest to longest                                   | 7h15-8h30          | 7h15-8h30               | an early starts before 11:00 · any day of the week                                                     |
| Late shifts, shortest to longest                                    | 7h30-9h10          | 7h30-9h10               | a late starts at 11:00 or after · any day of the week                                                  |
| Closing shift — weekday · Sat · Sun                                 | 8h40 · 9h10 · 8h55 | 7h30 · 7h30-9h10 · 8h55 | the shift that locks up                                                                                |
| How far the start time moves from one week to the next — on average | 4h00               | 3h57                    | smaller is easier on the body clock                                                                    |
| Finishing at 23:00 or later — each, a year                          | 39                 | 48                      | about one extra every 6 weeks                                                                          |
| Starting at 06:20, the open — each, a year                          | 62                 | 54                      | about one fewer every 6 or 7 weeks                                                                     |
| Saturdays worked — each, a year                                     | 26                 | 26                      | a rostered Saturday is paid at time and a quarter; cover weeks not counted                             |
| Sunday overtime to share — each, a year                             | 21                 | 20                      | Sundays are overtime, as today                                                                         |
| Different shift times                                               | 18                 | 19 (13 worked today)    | 6 new to learn, on 14 of the 20 working weeks — on page 4, the times with no figure under today's link |
| Avoidable tiring patterns (ORR and rail-industry lists)             | 5                  | 3                       | early starts and a weekly rotation come with every link                                                |
| December staffing rules met                                         | 4 of 11            | 3 of 11                 | staffing levels confirmed verbally, 29 Sep 2026                                                        |

## The rest of this sheet — the workings

- 3 The rota** — all 24 weeks, day by day, with hours and days worked
- 4 A week, and every shift time** — beside the ones worked today
- 5 People on duty, hour by hour** — against the December trains
- 6 The limits and the eleven December rules** — each one, with today's link beside it
- 7 The fatigue checks** — the Office of Rail and Road's list, in full
- 8 How the figures are worked out**

THE ROTATION

# The 24-line link

Sunday to Saturday per line; everyone moves down one line each week and line 24 goes back to line 1. Hours and days at the right, cover beneath.

| LINE    | SUN            | MON            | TUE            | WED            | THU            | FRI            | SAT            | MON-SAT<br>hours | ALL WEEK<br>hours | DAYS WORKED<br>Mon-Sat | TURNS<br>Mon-Fri    |
|---------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|------------------|-------------------|------------------------|---------------------|
| 1       | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | 35h 00m          | 35h 00m           | —                      | —                   |
| 2       | 14:30<br>23:25 | 16:25<br>23:55 | 16:25<br>23:55 | 16:25<br>23:55 | 16:25<br>23:55 | RD             | RD             | 30h 00m          | 38h 55m           | 4                      | <b>1</b>            |
| 3       | 07:15<br>15:45 | RD             | 08:30<br>16:30 | 06:20<br>14:20 | 06:20<br>14:20 | 06:20<br>14:20 | 06:20<br>14:20 | 40h 00m          | 48h 30m           | 5                      | 2                   |
| 4       | RD             | RD             | 06:20<br>14:20 | 08:30<br>16:30 | RD             | 13:30<br>22:00 | 14:45<br>23:55 | 33h 40m          | 33h 40m           | 4                      | 3                   |
| 5       | 14:30<br>23:25 | RD             | 14:00<br>22:30 | 14:00<br>22:30 | 14:00<br>22:30 | 16:25<br>23:55 | RD             | 33h 00m          | 41h 55m           | 4                      | 2                   |
| 6       | RD             | 06:20<br>14:20 | 07:00<br>15:30 | 07:00<br>15:30 | 07:00<br>15:30 | 08:30<br>17:00 | RD             | 42h 00m          | 42h 00m           | 5                      | 3                   |
| 7       | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | 35h 00m          | 35h 00m           | —                      | —                   |
| 8       | 07:15<br>15:45 | 06:20<br>13:45 | RD             | RD             | 13:30<br>22:00 | 14:00<br>22:30 | 13:30<br>21:00 | 31h 55m          | 40h 25m           | 4                      | 3                   |
| 9       | RD             | 12:00<br>20:30 | 12:00<br>20:30 | 12:00<br>20:30 | 12:00<br>20:30 | 12:00<br>20:30 | RD             | 42h 30m          | 42h 30m           | 5                      | <b>1</b>            |
| 10      | RD             | 14:00<br>22:30 | 16:25<br>23:55 | 16:25<br>23:55 | 16:25<br>23:55 | 16:25<br>23:55 | 14:45<br>23:55 | 47h 40m          | 47h 40m           | 6                      | 2                   |
| 11      | RD             | 07:00<br>15:30 | 07:00<br>15:30 | RD             | RD             | 06:20<br>13:35 | 06:20<br>14:50 | 32h 45m          | 32h 45m           | 4                      | 2                   |
| 12      | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | 35h 00m          | 35h 00m           | —                      | —                   |
| 13      | RD             | RD             | 14:00<br>22:30 | 13:30<br>22:00 | 14:00<br>22:30 | 14:00<br>22:30 | 14:30<br>22:00 | 41h 30m          | 41h 30m           | 5                      | 2                   |
| 14      | RD             | 16:25<br>23:55 | 16:25<br>23:55 | RD             | RD             | 07:00<br>15:30 | 06:20<br>14:50 | 32h 00m          | 32h 00m           | 4                      | 2                   |
| 15      | 07:15<br>15:45 | RD             | 06:20<br>13:35 | 06:20<br>13:35 | 06:20<br>13:35 | 07:00<br>15:30 | RD             | 30h 15m          | 38h 45m           | 4                      | 2                   |
| 16      | RD             | 06:20<br>13:45 | 08:30<br>17:00 | 08:30<br>17:00 | RD             | RD             | RD             | 24h 25m          | 24h 25m           | 3                      | 2                   |
| 17      | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | SP             | 35h 00m          | 35h 00m           | —                      | —                   |
| 18      | 10:30<br>19:00 | 16:25<br>23:55 | RD             | RD             | 06:20<br>14:20 | 06:20<br>14:20 | 06:20<br>14:50 | 32h 00m          | 40h 30m           | 4                      | 2                   |
| 19      | 14:30<br>23:25 | RD             | 06:20<br>13:45 | 06:20<br>13:45 | 06:20<br>13:45 | 06:20<br>13:45 | 08:00<br>16:00 | 37h 40m          | 46h 35m           | 5                      | 1                   |
| 20      | 08:30<br>16:30 | 06:20<br>13:45 | RD             | RD             | 13:30<br>22:00 | 16:25<br>23:55 | 13:30<br>22:00 | 31h 55m          | 39h 55m           | 4                      | 3                   |
| 21      | 13:30<br>22:00 | 13:30<br>22:00 | RD             | 13:30<br>22:00 | 13:30<br>22:00 | 13:00<br>21:00 | RD             | 33h 30m          | 42h 00m           | 4                      | 2                   |
| 22      | RD             | 14:00<br>22:30 | 13:30<br>22:00 | 13:30<br>22:00 | 13:30<br>22:00 | RD             | RD             | 34h 00m          | 34h 00m           | 4                      | 2                   |
| 23      | RD             | 08:30<br>17:00 | RD             | 16:25<br>23:55 | 16:25<br>23:55 | 16:25<br>23:55 | 16:25<br>23:55 | 38h 30m          | 38h 30m           | 5                      | 2                   |
| 24      | RD             | RD             | 06:20<br>13:45 | 06:20<br>13:45 | 07:00<br>15:30 | RD             | 06:20<br>13:45 | 30h 45m          | 30h 45m           | 4                      | 2                   |
| On duty | 9<br>SP 4      | 13<br>SP 4     | 15<br>SP 4     | 15<br>SP 4     | 16<br>SP 4     | 16<br>SP 4     | 12<br>SP 4     | 35h 00m          | 38h 13m           | 4.35                   | 2<br>one-turn weeks |
| Minutes | 4,635          | 6,225          | 7,205          | 7,205          | 7,780          | 7,690          | 5,895          | 42,000           | 46,635            |                        |                     |

Early turns
Late turns
Cover (spare) week
— four duties of seven, any turn
Rest day

Mon-Sat hours average 35h 00m over 24 lines, a cover week counted as a contracted week · days worked average over the 20 working lines · Turns: how many different shift times the week works Monday to Friday; **bold** marks a one-turn week (see below) · Minutes: total duty minutes each day — Monday to Saturday adds up to the contract (35 hours for each of the 20 working weeks = 42,000 minutes)

## The words on this page

**Link** — the whole rota: 24 weeks laid out as 24 lines. Everyone works line 1, then line 2, and so on round the wheel; the link needs 24 people.

**Line** — one week of the pattern, Sunday to Saturday. You move down a line each week, and line 24 goes back to line 1.

**Turn** — a shift time, such as 06:20-13:35. An **early** starts before 11:00; a **late** starts at 11:00 or later.

**Rest day (RD)** — a day off inside the contracted week. Two together make a proper break; one on its own does not count as a 48-hour break.

**Cover (spare) week** — a week with no fixed times. You work four duties of the seven days, placed by the roster clerk to cover leave and sickness.

**Sunday** — not part of the contract. A Sunday duty is rest-day working, paid on top of the week, which is why the hours are shown Mon-Sat and all week.

**The contract** — 35 hours a week, averaged over the 24 lines; a cover week counts as a full contracted week.

**One-turn week** — one clock time Monday to Friday, with every day of the week an early or every day a late (shown bold in the Turns column); the easiest kind of week to live around.

**The floor** — staff out on the station (gates, concourse, platforms); the ticket office joins it only at the quiet ends (page 5).

**Opener / closer** — the first people on duty in the morning and the last at night.

**Handover** — the overlap when one shift takes over from another.

**Match** — how closely the number of people on the floor follows the number of trains through the day (page 5); 0 is a perfect match, lower is better.

# A week, and the duty table

How a working week compares with today's, and every shift time beside the ones worked today.

## The shape of a week, against today

| MEASURE                                                      | TODAY (20)          | PROPOSED (24)                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Weeks on one shift time — all earlies or all lates           | 7 of 16             | <b>2 of 20</b>                    |
| Weeks mixing early and late shifts                           | 7                   | <b>7</b>                          |
| Rest-day breaks of two days or more (of all rest-day breaks) | 13 of 17            | <b>15 of 27</b>                   |
| Single rest days between duties (not a 48h break)            | 4                   | <b>12</b> (1 beside a cover week) |
| Days worked in a week (Sunday included; weeks × days)        | 1×3, 3×4, 11×5, 1×6 | <b>1×3, 5×4, 11×5, 3×6</b>        |
| Cover (spare) weeks (whole weeks)                            | lines 1, 7, 12, 17  | <b>lines 1, 7, 12, 17</b>         |
| Different shift times (6 not worked today)                   | 18                  | <b>19</b>                         |
| Mon–Sat hours, average week (the contract)                   | 35h 00m             | <b>35h 00m</b>                    |
| Sunday duties (not contracted)                               | 8 of 16 lines       | <b>9 of 20 lines</b>              |

## How many people are working

| PEOPLE WORKING                                                 | TODAY     | PROPOSED           | WHY                                                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Monday to Friday                                               | 11–12     | <b>13–16</b>       | 24 people instead of 20, so more on each weekday                                                  |
| Saturday                                                       | 10        | <b>12</b>          | short of the December 2026 figure of 14                                                           |
| Sunday                                                         | 8         | <b>9</b>           | short of the December 2026 figure of 10                                                           |
| Ticket office Mon–Fri · Sat · Sun                              | 4 · 4 · 3 | <b>4 · 4 · 4</b>   | rostered as pairs on Thu and Fri; the plan's posts assumed on Mon, Tue, Wed, Sat and Sun (page 6) |
| Opening at 06:20 (07:15 Sunday) Mon–Fri · Sat · Sun            | 4 · 4 · 3 | <b>4 · 5 · 3</b>   | at least four to open, every day — not met: Sunday 3                                              |
| Through to the close (23:55; 23:25 Sunday) Mon–Fri · Sat · Sun | 2 · 2 · 3 | <b>3–4 · 3 · 3</b> | at least three to close, every day — met                                                          |
| Still on duty at 22:00 Mon–Fri · Sat · Sun                     | 4 · 2 · 3 | <b>4–6 · 3 · 3</b> | at least five from 22:00, every day — not met: Wed 4, Saturday 3, Sunday 3                        |

## The duty table, beside today's

| SHIFT TIME                 | TODAY'S LINK |     |               | PROPOSED      |               |               |
|----------------------------|--------------|-----|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
|                            | MON-FRI      | SAT | SUN           | MON-FRI       | SAT           | SUN           |
| 06:20–13:35 7h 15m · Early | 1            |     | 1             |               |               |               |
| 06:20–13:45 7h 25m · Early | 1            |     | <b>3</b> (+2) | <b>1</b> (+1) |               |               |
| 06:20–14:00 7h 40m · Early |              | 1   |               | <b>0</b> (–1) |               |               |
| 06:20–14:20 8h 00m · Early | 2            |     | 2             | <b>1</b> (+1) |               |               |
| 06:20–14:50 8h 30m · Early |              | 3   |               | <b>3</b>      |               |               |
| 07:00–15:30 8h 30m · Early |              |     | <b>2</b> (+2) |               |               |               |
| 07:15–15:45 8h 30m · Early |              |     | 3             |               | <b>3</b>      |               |
| 08:00–16:00 8h 00m · Early |              |     |               | <b>1</b> (+1) |               |               |
| 08:00–16:30 8h 30m · Early | 2            |     | <b>0</b> (–2) |               |               |               |
| 08:30–16:30 8h 00m · Early |              |     | 1             | <b>1</b> (+1) |               | 1             |
| 08:30–17:00 8h 30m · Early |              |     | <b>1</b> (+1) |               |               |               |
| 10:30–19:00 8h 30m · Early |              |     |               |               |               | <b>1</b> (+1) |
| 11:00–19:30 8h 30m · Late  | 1            |     | <b>0</b> (–1) |               |               |               |
| 12:00–20:00 8h 00m · Late  |              | 1   |               | <b>0</b> (–1) |               |               |
| 12:00–20:30 8h 30m · Late  |              |     | <b>1</b> (+1) |               |               |               |
| 13:00–21:00 8h 00m · Late  |              |     | 1             | <b>1</b> (+1) |               | <b>0</b> (–1) |
| 13:30–21:00 7h 30m · Late  |              | 1   |               | <b>1</b>      |               |               |
| 13:30–22:00 8h 30m · Late  | 1            |     | <b>4</b> (+3) | <b>1</b> (+1) | <b>1</b> (+1) |               |
| 14:00–22:30 8h 30m · Late  | 2            |     | <b>2</b>      |               |               |               |
| 14:30–22:00 7h 30m · Late  |              | 2   |               | <b>1</b> (–1) |               |               |
| 14:30–23:25 8h 55m · Late  |              |     | 3             |               |               | <b>3</b>      |
| 14:45–23:55 9h 10m · Late  |              | 2   |               | <b>2</b>      |               |               |
| 15:15–23:55 8h 40m · Late  | 2            |     | <b>0</b> (–2) |               |               |               |
| 16:25–23:55 7h 30m · Late  |              |     | <b>4</b> (+4) | <b>1</b> (+1) |               |               |

People on each shift time on a Saturday, a Sunday and — under Mon–Fri — the weekday with most of that time, so Mon–Fri can add up to more than work on one day. Green: more than today; amber: fewer; grey italics: a time the proposal drops.

Monday to Friday add up to 36,105 minutes of duty and Saturday 5,895 — together exactly 42,000 minutes — 35 hours for each of the 20 working weeks, the contract (a cover week counts as a full 35-hour week on top). Sunday adds 4,635, paid on top of the contracted week. 6 of the 19 shift times are new — nobody works them today.

# People on duty, hour by hour

Today's link and the proposal, hour by hour, against the December 2026 timetable. A darker orange hour carries more of the day's trains.

- Blue squares** — how many people are on duty in that hour (darker blue = more). Anyone on duty for any part of the hour counts, so a handover counts both people.
- Orange row** — the train service: carriages arriving and leaving in that hour (darker orange = more service). A guide from the timetable, not passenger numbers.
- Read down each column** — the most people should be under the darkest orange.
- Match**, the right-hand column — how closely the floor follows the trains over the whole day. 0 is a perfect match; lower is better.

## Monday to Friday

staffed 06:20–23:55 · a row for each different weekday

|                                      | 05 | 06 | 07  | 08  | 09  | 10 | 11 | 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16  | 17  | 18  | 19  | 20 | 21 | 22 | 23 | MATCH |
|--------------------------------------|----|----|-----|-----|-----|----|----|----|----|----|----|-----|-----|-----|-----|----|----|----|----|-------|
| TODAY, MON · WED — ALL ON DUTY       |    | 4  | 4   | 6   | 6   | 6  | 7  | 7  | 7  | 7  | 7  | 7   | 5   | 5   | 5   | 4  | 4  | 4  | 2  |       |
| TODAY, TUE · THU · FRI — ALL ON DUTY |    | 4  | 4   | 6   | 6   | 6  | 7  | 7  | 8  | 8  | 8  | 8   | 6   | 6   | 6   | 5  | 5  | 4  | 2  |       |
| OF WHOM IN THE TICKET OFFICE         |    | 1  | 1   | 2   | 2   | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 4  | 2  | 2   | 2   | 2   | 1   | 1  | 1  | 1  |    |       |
| OF WHOM ON THE FLOOR MON · WED       |    | 3  | 3   | 4   | 4   | 4  | 5  | 5  | 5  | 3  | 5  | 5   | 3   | 3   | 4   | 3  | 3  | 3  | 2  | 61.1  |
| OF WHOM ON THE FLOOR TUE · THU · FRI |    | 3  | 3   | 4   | 4   | 4  | 5  | 5  | 6  | 4  | 6  | 6   | 4   | 4   | 5   | 4  | 4  | 3  | 2  | 50.1  |
| PROPOSED, MON — ALL ON DUTY          |    | 4  | 5   | 6   | 6   | 6  | 6  | 7  | 8  | 7  | 6  | 8   | 7   | 7   | 7   | 7  | 6  | 5  | 3  |       |
| PROPOSED, TUE — ALL ON DUTY          |    | 4  | 6   | 8   | 8   | 8  | 8  | 9  | 10 | 9  | 8  | 9   | 7   | 7   | 7   | 7  | 6  | 5  | 3  |       |
| PROPOSED, WED — ALL ON DUTY          |    | 4  | 5   | 7   | 7   | 7  | 7  | 8  | 11 | 9  | 8  | 10  | 8   | 8   | 8   | 8  | 7  | 4  | 3  |       |
| PROPOSED, THU — ALL ON DUTY          |    | 4  | 6   | 6   | 6   | 6  | 6  | 7  | 11 | 11 | 9  | 10  | 10  | 10  | 10  | 10 | 9  | 5  | 3  |       |
| PROPOSED, FRI — ALL ON DUTY          |    | 4  | 6   | 7   | 7   | 7  | 7  | 8  | 10 | 10 | 8  | 10  | 9   | 9   | 9   | 9  | 7  | 6  | 4  |       |
| OF WHOM IN THE TICKET OFFICE         |    | 1  | 1   | 2   | 2   | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 4  | 2  | 2   | 2   | 2   | 1   | 1  | 1  | 1  |    |       |
| OF WHOM ON THE FLOOR MON             |    | 3  | 4   | 4   | 4   | 4  | 4  | 5  | 6  | 3  | 4  | 6   | 5   | 5   | 6   | 6  | 5  | 4  | 3  | 35.5  |
| OF WHOM ON THE FLOOR TUE             |    | 3  | 5   | 6   | 6   | 6  | 6  | 7  | 8  | 5  | 6  | 7   | 5   | 5   | 6   | 6  | 5  | 4  | 3  | 44.7  |
| OF WHOM ON THE FLOOR WED             |    | 3  | 4   | 5   | 5   | 5  | 5  | 6  | 9  | 5  | 6  | 8   | 6   | 6   | 7   | 7  | 6  | 3  | 3  | 46.2  |
| OF WHOM ON THE FLOOR THU             |    | 3  | 5   | 4   | 4   | 4  | 4  | 5  | 9  | 7  | 7  | 8   | 8   | 8   | 9   | 9  | 8  | 4  | 3  | 66.1  |
| OF WHOM ON THE FLOOR FRI             |    | 3  | 5   | 5   | 5   | 5  | 5  | 6  | 8  | 6  | 6  | 8   | 7   | 7   | 8   | 8  | 6  | 5  | 4  | 37.1  |
| TRAINS — CARRIAGES IN AND OUT        | 5  | 69 | 107 | 127 | 122 | 95 | 85 | 75 | 84 | 79 | 87 | 105 | 140 | 138 | 107 | 90 | 73 | 75 | 66 |       |

## Saturday

staffed 06:20–23:55

|                               | 05 | 06 | 07 | 08 | 09 | 10 | 11 | 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 | 17 | 18 | 19 | 20 | 21 | 22 | 23 | MATCH |
|-------------------------------|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|-------|
| TODAY — ALL ON DUTY           |    | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 5  | 6  | 9  | 6  | 6  | 6  | 6  | 6  | 5  | 4  | 2  | 2  |       |
| OF WHOM IN THE TICKET OFFICE  |    | 1  | 1  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 4  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 1  | 1  | 1  |    |    |       |
| OF WHOM ON THE FLOOR          |    | 3  | 3  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 3  | 4  | 5  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 5  | 4  | 3  | 2  | 2  | 65.9  |
| PROPOSED — ALL ON DUTY        |    | 5  | 5  | 6  | 6  | 6  | 6  | 6  | 8  | 10 | 6  | 6  | 6  | 6  | 6  | 6  | 5  | 3  | 3  |       |
| OF WHOM IN THE TICKET OFFICE  |    | 1  | 1  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 4  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 1  | 1  | 1  |    |    |       |
| OF WHOM ON THE FLOOR          |    | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 6  | 6  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 5  | 5  | 4  | 3  | 3  | 20.7  |
| TRAINS — CARRIAGES IN AND OUT | 6  | 24 | 58 | 75 | 81 | 92 | 88 | 77 | 64 | 68 | 72 | 84 | 82 | 67 | 64 | 79 | 78 | 62 | 41 |       |

## Sunday

staffed 07:15–23:25

|                               | 05 | 06 | 07 | 08 | 09 | 10 | 11 | 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 | 17 | 18 | 19 | 20 | 21 | 22 | 23 | MATCH |
|-------------------------------|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|-------|
| TODAY — ALL ON DUTY           |    |    | 3  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 5  | 8  | 8  | 5  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 3  | 3  | 3  |       |
| OF WHOM IN THE TICKET OFFICE  |    |    | 1  | 1  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 3  | 3  | 1  | 1  | 1  | 1  | 1  | 1  | 1  |    |       |
| OF WHOM ON THE FLOOR          |    |    | 2  | 3  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 3  | 5  | 5  | 4  | 3  | 3  | 3  | 3  | 2  | 2  | 3  | 71.7  |
| PROPOSED — ALL ON DUTY        |    |    | 3  | 4  | 4  | 5  | 5  | 5  | 6  | 9  | 9  | 6  | 5  | 5  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 3  | 3  |       |
| OF WHOM IN THE TICKET OFFICE  |    |    | 1  | 1  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 2  |    |       |
| OF WHOM ON THE FLOOR          |    |    | 2  | 3  | 2  | 3  | 3  | 3  | 2  | 5  | 5  | 4  | 3  | 3  | 2  | 2  | 2  | 1  | 3  | 64.8  |
| TRAINS — CARRIAGES IN AND OUT |    |    | 15 | 45 | 65 | 71 | 74 | 71 | 61 | 55 | 64 | 69 | 78 | 73 | 75 | 52 | 71 | 65 | 50 |       |

## Good to know

- The ticket office.** Its staff are not floor cover, bar one of each pair at the quiet ends (until 08:00, or 09:00 Sunday; from 19:30; half on a Sunday evening). Today's office matches the plan except on **Sunday**: two earlys and **one** late (a 14:30–23:25 closer, in the office until 22:30), where the plan has two and two. This design rosters the office pairs on Thu and Fri; on Mon, Tue, Wed, Sat and Sun its floor figure is everyone on duty minus the four office posts the plan asks for. The “of whom” rows split it out of each side, so the floor rows compare like with like.
- Only the floor is matched to the trains.** The ticket office is staffed to its opening hours, not to the trains, so its rows carry no match figure. Page 1's weekday figure is worked out from the five weekdays combined, so it is not an average of the scores shown.
- More than one weekday row.** Where weekdays are staffed differently, each different weekday gets its own row, labelled with its days.
- Cover weeks.** They are not in these figures — a cover week has no fixed times — so real cover is a little higher.
- Sunday's last trains.** On Sundays five trains in the December 2026 timetable arrive or leave after the 23:25 finish (the last at 23:54); the bar under the Sunday 23:00 hour marks the time after the finish. No duty runs past 23:25 on a Sunday — that is agreed practice and stays so (settled 28 Sep 2026) — so those trains fall outside the staffed day of any link, today's included.

**Reading the match.** It measures **shape, not numbers** — each hour's share of the day's staff against its share of the day's trains — so an extra person in a quiet hour makes it worse even though nobody is worse off. Read it beside the numbers of people, never alone.

# Hard limits and the December 2026 rules

Hard limits first — met or not. Then the December 2026 rules, each met or not. The fatigue factors are on page 7.

**Hard limits** — a design either meets these or cannot be run

- ✓ **No more than 13 days worked in a row** — longest possible run **9** days (today 9)  
Longest possible run is 9 days, within Chiltern's limit of 13. A cover week is 4 duties in 7 days and the roster clerk places them, so this is the worst case the link allows. Worked as a block of four rather than split day-on-day-off, the worst case is the same — **9** days. It does depend on where the roster clerk puts the four: placed well, the longest run is **7** days.  
The written source of the 13-day limit is still to be confirmed.
- ✓ **At least 12 hours between duties** — **0** rests under 12h anywhere in the rotation, Saturday-into-Sunday and line-into-line included (today 0)  
Tightest anywhere: **13h 35m — line 20 Fri 16:25-23:55 into Sat 13:30-22:00** (today's tightest: 12h 30m).
- ✓ **The contracted week, exactly** — **35h 00m** average Mon–Sat over the 24 lines, cover weeks counted as contracted weeks  
700h of duty a week across 20 working lines. Sunday duties (77h 15m in all) are paid on top as rest-day working, as they are today. Individual weeks range 24h 25m–47h 40m; only the average is the contract.

**The December 2026 rules** — each one, with today's link beside it

| RULE                                                                   | TODAY'S LINK                       | THIS PROPOSAL                                                | WHAT THE RULE ASKS                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| At least four on at the open, every day                                | × 4 · 4 · 3                        | × 4 · 5 · 3                                                  | from 06:20 (07:15 on a Sunday)                                                                                                                                     |
| At least three through to the close, every day                         | × 2 · 2 · 3                        | ✓ 3–4 · 3 · 3                                                | until 23:55 (23:25 on a Sunday)                                                                                                                                    |
| At least five still on duty at 22:00, every day                        | × 4 · 2 · 3                        | × 4–6 · 3 · 3                                                | someone finishing at 22:00 does not count                                                                                                                          |
| Fourteen on a Saturday, ten on a Sunday                                | × 10 · 8                           | × 12 · 9                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Four cover weeks, evenly spread                                        | × lines 1, 7, 12, 17               | × lines 1, 7, 12, 17                                         | evenly means every 6 lines, e.g. 1, 7, 13, 19                                                                                                                      |
| The ticket office: two early and two late, identical shifts, every day | × Mon–Fri yes · Sat yes · Sun no   | × Mon–Fri no · Sat no · Sun no                               | Mon–Fri 06:20–14:20 and 14:00–22:30; Sat 06:20–14:50 and 14:30–22:00; Sun two from 07:15 and two to 22:30                                                          |
| Every weekday closer starts at 15:45                                   | × closers start at 15:15           | × closers start at 16:25                                     |                                                                                                                                                                    |
| At least two on the floor at every moment                              | ✓ fewest 2 · 2 · 2                 | × fewest 3 · 3 · 1                                           | the ticket office counts only while its second person helps on the floor (until 08:00 or 09:00 on a Sunday, and from 19:30); checked every five minutes            |
| Handovers: 15 minutes to each closer, 20 in the ticket office          | ✓ floor met · ticket office 20 min | ✓ floor met · ticket office 20 min (posts on 5 days assumed) | on a Sunday each opener also stays until 15 minutes after the last closer arrives; where the design does not roster the office pairs, the plan's posts are assumed |
| Sunday duties between 8h and 9h                                        | ✓ 8h 00m–8h 55m                    | ✓ 8h 00m–8h 55m                                              |                                                                                                                                                                    |
| No more shift times than today                                         | ✓ 18                               | × 19                                                         | today 18                                                                                                                                                           |

## Still to settle

- **8 of the 11 December 2026 rules are not met** — At least four on at the open, every day; At least five still on duty at 22:00, every day; Fourteen on a Saturday, ten on a Sunday; Four cover weeks, evenly spread; The ticket office: two early and two late, identical shifts, every day; Every weekday closer starts at 15:45; At least two on the floor at every moment; No more shift times than today. The shaded rows above give the figures.
- **New shift times.** 6 of the 19 are times nobody works today; page 4 lists them.

## ORR fatigue factors

From the ORR's good-practice guidance, *Fatigue Factors*, page 3 (December 2021).  $\triangle$  present — the pattern is in this design and worth a look, not a breach ·  $\checkmark$  clear — it is not ·  $\bullet$  standing — comes with the station's hours or with any rotating link, not with this design's choices · – means it does not apply here.

These are 25 roster patterns that tend to tire people — 21 from the Office of Rail and Road's good-practice list and 4 checks from the rail industry's fatigue guidance (MRSF) — long runs of earlies, short gaps between duties, start times that jump about. For each one this table asks whether the pattern is in the rotation, today and proposed, and how big it is. The list is guidance: a factor present is a question to discuss, never a pass or a fail, and a design showing nothing is not thereby approved.

| CODE | FACTOR                                                                                               | TODAY'S LINK                                         | PROPOSED                                             |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| FF2  | Early shift starting 05:00–07:00 <small>Time of day</small>                                          | $\bullet$ 24                                         | $\bullet$ 25                                         |
| FF3  | Very early shift starting before 05:00 <small>Time of day</small>                                    | $\checkmark$ 0                                       | $\checkmark$ 0                                       |
| FF5  | Day shift over 12h <small>Duty length</small>                                                        | $\checkmark$ 0                                       | $\checkmark$ 0                                       |
| FF7  | Early shift over 10h <small>Duty length</small>                                                      | $\checkmark$ 0                                       | $\checkmark$ 0                                       |
| FF8b | Fewer than 2 days rest after a block of early starts <small>Recovery time</small>                    | $\triangle$ 3                                        | $\triangle$ 5                                        |
| FF11 | More than 13 consecutive shifts without a 48h break <small>Recovery time</small>                     | $\checkmark$ 12<br>$\checkmark$ 9 as rostered        | $\checkmark$ 13<br>$\checkmark$ 11 as rostered       |
| FF10 | More than 4 consecutive 12h day shifts <small>Cumulative</small>                                     | $\checkmark$ 0                                       | $\checkmark$ 0                                       |
| FF15 | More than 4 consecutive early shifts in a rotating pattern <small>Cumulative</small>                 | $\triangle$ 6                                        | $\triangle$ 6                                        |
| MRSF | More than 12 consecutive day shifts <small>Cumulative</small>                                        | $\checkmark$ 9                                       | $\checkmark$ 9                                       |
| MRSF | More than 55 hours worked in any 7-day period <small>Cumulative</small>                              | $\triangle$ 60.8                                     | $\checkmark$ 53.1                                    |
| MRSF | More than 7 consecutive 8h shifts <small>Cumulative</small>                                          | $\triangle$ 9                                        | $\checkmark$ 5                                       |
| FF17 | Backward rotating pattern <small>Circadian</small>                                                   | $\checkmark$ 10 backward / 12 forward                | $\checkmark$ 11 backward / 19 forward                |
| FF18 | Rotating pattern of about a week <small>Circadian</small>                                            | $\bullet$ 20-line rotation · typically 4h 00m a week | $\bullet$ 24-line rotation · typically 3h 57m a week |
| FF19 | Successive start times varying by more than 2 hours (definition to confirm) <small>Circadian</small> | $\triangle$ 6                                        | $\triangle$ 10                                       |
| FF13 | Less than 12h rest in any 24h <small>Intervals between duties</small>                                | $\checkmark$ 0                                       | $\checkmark$ 0                                       |

Also on the list, and applying to neither link: time of day (FF1) · duty length (FF4) · cumulative (MRSF) · night shifts (FF6, FF8, FF9, FF12, FF14, FF16, FF20).

- Avoidable tiring patterns found: 3 (today 5).
- **Standing factors ( $\bullet$ ) are recorded for information, not counted.** FF2 comes with the station's 06:20 open, and FF18 — the ORR's concern with a rotation that changes shift type about once a week (*Managing rail staff fatigue*, 7.68) — comes with every weekly link, which moves everyone one line a week by construction; its week-to-week step is shown as information.
- **How to read the table.** The figure beside each mark is the worst case found, for today's link as for the proposal, except where a row counts only the duties the rota fixes: the 55-hour row counts a cover week as no hours, and FF8b counts none of its days as early. "As rostered" under FF11 is the worst of the places a cover week's four duties could fall when worked together, which is usual. The MRSF rows are extra checks from the rail industry's guidance on managing staff fatigue, listed beside the ORR's own. FF2 and FF15 use the ORR's early — a start from 05:00 up to 06:59, not the 11:00 used elsewhere on this sheet; the station opens at 06:20, so every link has FF2. FF11 counts shifts between two-day breaks, so a single rest day does not reset it — that is why it can be longer than the most days worked in a row.
- **Cover weeks.** A cover week's four duties can fall in different ways, and on this design that moves the most days worked in a row (7 if placed well), the run of early starts, FF15 (4 if placed well), FF11 (13 if spread out, 11 if worked together) and the 55-hour row, which counts a cover week as no hours: 53.1–55.9 if the four are worked as 8-hour duties, which would make it present. Where they fall is for the roster office. This page is an aid to discussion, not a fatigue risk assessment.

# How the figures are worked out

In plain words — what each figure means and what it does not.

## Where the figures come from

Every figure is worked out from the rota itself — the 24 weeks on page 3 — by the Marylebone Roster app. None is typed in by hand, and the same calculation is run on today's link.

## Cover weeks

A cover week is marked on all seven days but works four of them, placed by the roster clerk. It counts as a full contracted week of hours and as four days at work. Where a figure depends on where those four fall, the worst case is shown. Cover-week shift times are not known in advance, so the yearly counts of early and late starts, Saturdays and Sundays, and the rest gaps between shifts, cover the fixed duties only; whatever is later given in a cover week must still be rostered within the normal limits.

## Sundays

Sunday is not in the contract: Sunday duties are overtime, as today. So "days at work" and the 35-hour week are Monday to Saturday. A Sunday off costs no annual leave.

## Each person, a year

Figures given "each, a year" are averages across the whole link: every week's duties, times 52, divided by the number of people; these counts include Sunday overtime duties. "Days at work a year" is Monday to Saturday only: the days a week times  $365 \div 7$ . Somebody's own year depends on which week they start on.

## Following the trains

For each hour, the share of the day's floor staff on duty is set against the share of the day's train movements in the December 2026 timetable. Hour by hour, the difference between the two shares is squared — so a big mismatch counts far more than several small ones — and the squares are added up and multiplied by 10,000. 0 would be a perfect match; lower is closer. The staff share is worked out from the minutes each person spends on the floor, with the ticket office's fixed posts taken out — finer than the whole-person counts on page 5, where a person counts in every hour they are on duty for any part of, so a handover inside an hour counts both people. It measures the shape of the day, not a staffing requirement or passenger numbers, and it compares shares, not headcounts: an extra person in a quiet hour makes the figure worse although nobody is worse off. The ticket office is left out, except its second person helping at the quiet ends.

The rota is supplied beside this PDF as Cover-at-Seventeen-C17-24-EXT-import.txt, ready to paste into the Links page (Import), which re-runs every check here from the pasted weeks. The code **edc1b731** in every footer is worked out from the 168 days of the rota and nothing else, so a printout always matches the design it came from.

## Rest, runs and weekends

The shortest gap is one gap — the tightest anywhere, Saturday into Sunday and the last week into the first included; a rota with many gaps just over 12 hours reads the same as one with none. The most days in a row counts every day with a duty, Sunday overtime included, and is the worst case, with a cover week's four duties placed as badly as they can be. A full weekend off is a Saturday off followed by a Sunday off.

## Familiar shift times

How many of the shift times somebody already works today. A rough guide to how much there is to learn, not to what staff will accept.

## Fatigue

The Office of Rail and Road's good-practice list of roster patterns that tend to tire people, with four rail-industry checks. It is guidance, not a pass or fail, and this is not a fatigue risk assessment. Two patterns — early starts at a 06:20 station, and a weekly rotation — come with every link, today's included, so they are recorded on page 7 and not counted. In the ORR's checks an early start is one from 05:00 up to 06:59; a "block" of earlies is two or more in a row; the start-time rows count how many times a start moves by more than two hours (a count, not hours); and the week-to-week move is the average change in a week's mean start time, Sundays included and cover weeks left out.

## What is confirmed

The December 2026 staffing levels, a 24-person link and the Sunday cover were confirmed verbally on 29 September 2026. The written source of Chiltern's 13-day limit is still to be confirmed.

## How firm each figure is

Firm: the rest gaps, the contract, the days in a row and the staffing counts — worked out from the rota and checked again by the app. Confirmed verbally: the December staffing levels. Advisory: the fatigue patterns — guidance, never a pass or fail. A guide: how closely staff follow the trains, and how familiar the shift times are.

## What no page can tell you

Whether staff accept the new shift times; where the roster clerk places a cover week's four duties; how leave and sickness cover land; whether the pattern holds on Wembley event days, since it follows the train timetable rather than passenger numbers; and who starts on which week. Those are for the people who work it and the managers who roster it.